

Dabar Canon Phrase Card Set

Edition: MVP Canon-Corrected Module Packet

Use: Prepared ordinary-play Dabar Phrases for Module 00, including the expansion set

Authority: *The Threl — Canon Rules & Mechanics Master Reference*, Version 1.0, updated 2026-08-30

These are prepared Phrase cards for use at the table. They are not invitations to construct new Phrases, recalculate glyph totals, or invoke the 37-glyph registry. The Ashenfold's fixed legacy formulae—such as KETH, KETH-BAR-ON, QAD VAEL, RUH, DUR, QAD, SATH, TAM, and GAL—remain separate, site-bound module procedures.

GM use

Give each participating Dabar user a small selection of these cards, or place the complete set where the party can choose from it. Each card already contains its ordinary-play cost, DC, effect, theological tag, and Failure Echo. The caster states a one-sentence intent, marks the printed Strain cost, and rolls once against the printed DC.

If the GM designates the current location as **Frayed**, the printed DC may be raised by the single **+2 Fray modifier**. Do not add the Ashenfold World Drift Score, Anchor modifiers, Vertical Friction, Major-Working Multiplier, or Linguistic Friction to an ordinary Phrase.

On a total below the printed DC, use one of the card's Failure Echoes. On a natural 1, use the Failure Echo and add a minor narrative complication. Do not roll on a separate Backlash table. At 6 Strain, the caster may declare **Force It** before rolling; apply the Master Reference Force It rules.

The Prodigal Dungeon — Module Phrase Cards

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Card 01 — Reading of the Hidden Chord

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Mystery
D&D 5e Counterpart	Detect Magic

Effect. For 10 minutes, you can perceive recent disturbances in the Lattice within 30 feet. The GM may reveal active Fray traces, recently displaced objects, a phase-crossing route, or the direction of the strongest nearby harmonic disturbance. This Phrase does not reveal thoughts, hidden creatures, or the full cause of a disturbance.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The reading returns as a second voice that repeats the caster's last sentence. Until a Short Rest, the caster's voice occasionally carries that second harmonic.
2. The caster receives a true trace in the wrong order. The GM reveals a real detail, but it points first toward the wrong recent event.

Module use. This card can identify the Static Stalker's ash trail and clarify that the Ashenfold columns are silent rather than broken.

Card 02 — Name the First Boundary

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Witness
D&D 5e Counterpart	See Invisibility

Effect. Name one visible creature, object, doorway, or bounded threshold within 30 feet. Until the end of your next turn, its position remains legible through ordinary darkness, smoke, visual distortion, and Fray flicker. If the named target is a creature with **Flicker**, that creature's Flicker is suppressed until the end of its next turn. This effect does not prevent movement or phasing after the duration ends.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The boundary holds around the wrong nearby target until the end of your next turn. The GM chooses a plausible target that becomes conspicuously outlined.
2. The named target is revealed, but so is the caster. Until the end of the caster's next turn, the caster's position is unmistakable to every creature within 30 feet.

Module use. This is the prepared Phrase that can anchor a Stridor-Wolf or Static Stalker against Flicker. The **Witness** tag does not grant that ability by itself; the printed effect does.

Card 03 — Veil of Unseen Footfalls

Field	Value
Level	Minor

Field	Value
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Mystery
D&D 5e Counterpart	Pass without Trace

Effect. One willing creature that you touch leaves no ordinary sound or physical track for 10 minutes. The creature remains visible unless another effect conceals it, and the Phrase does not hide evidence that already exists.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The creature disappears from sight for a heartbeat, but its footsteps remain visible as brief silver impressions until the end of its next turn.
2. The creature's tracks vanish, but the caster's last three steps become sharply visible to everyone nearby.

Card 04 — Keep the Unfinished Line

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalam
D&D 5e Counterpart	Protection from Evil and Good

Effect. Choose one visible door, passage, small structure, object, or willing creature within 30 feet. Until the start of your next turn, the target cannot be forcibly displaced, knocked through a boundary, or moved by a phasing effect. The Phrase does not repair damage, end a Condition, or prevent a creature from choosing to move itself.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The target holds, but the caster's hands become rigid and difficult to unclench until the end of the caster's next turn.
2. The line holds in the wrong place. The GM creates a visible seam or shifted edge in the nearest boundary; it is a narrative complication, not a numeric modifier.

Module use. This card can protect a character from a dangerous phase crossing or briefly hold a damaged threshold. It does not replace the Area 4 maintenance rite.

Card 05 — Mercy for the Neglected Thing

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Mercy / Chesed
D&D 5e Counterpart	Mending

Effect. Restore one damaged, neglected, nonmagical object no larger than a wardrobe to working order for one scene. The Phrase cannot create missing materials, restore a destroyed Lattice column, restore a dead creature, or replace the Tuning Codex. The object's restoration ends when the scene ends unless the GM determines that ordinary repair can preserve it.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The object works for one action, then repeats that action imperfectly. The GM describes a visible malfunction or partial repetition.
2. The object remembers its neglect. It works, but the caster bears a visible mark of dust, ash, or old wear until a Short Rest.

Module use. This card supports scavenging, opening neglected equipment, or giving a small abandoned object one last useful scene.

Card 06 — Witness the Remaining Light

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Grace
D&D 5e Counterpart	Detect Thoughts

Effect. Choose one willing creature within 30 feet. For 10 minutes, that creature can clearly perceive one truthful, emotionally significant detail that the surrounding silence is suppressing: a hidden inscription, the last position of a departed person, the source of a low harmonic, or the intended use of an abandoned object. The GM chooses a concrete detail that is useful but not a complete solution.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The detail becomes audible to everyone within 60 feet, including creatures the party hoped would not hear it.
2. The caster perceives the detail but cannot repeat it accurately until a Short Rest; another character must interpret the caster's gestures or partial words.

Card 07 — Break the Stutter

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Judgment
D&D 5e Counterpart	See Invisibility

Effect. Choose one Fray-corrupted creature within 30 feet. Until the end of your next turn, its phasing, displacement, or Flicker-like movement cannot conceal its current position. If the creature is using a named phasing action, that action is unavailable for the duration unless its own stat block says otherwise. This Phrase does not damage, banish, or permanently stabilize the creature.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The creature's outline becomes clear, but the caster's outline also becomes fixed and painfully visible. Until the end of the caster's next turn, the caster cannot benefit from concealment.
2. The creature stutters into two visible positions for a moment. The GM chooses which position is real, and the false position creates a minor narrative complication for the next exchange.

Module use. This is a high-cost emergency option against the Static Stalker or Stridor-Wolves. It is not the same as the Ashenfold Counterword KETH.

Card 08 — Restore the Permitted Measure

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalam
D&D 5e Counterpart	Mending

Effect. Restore one clearly bounded, nonliving Lattice function within 10 feet for 1 minute: a silent inscription can resonate, a failing boundary can hold, a damaged light can reveal a safe route, or a dormant maintenance mechanism can complete one simple permitted action. The Phrase cannot permanently restore the Ashenfold, complete the Area 4 rite, replace the Tuning Codex, or alter Campaign Ripple Drift during ordinary play.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The function returns for one heartbeat and leaves a named **Local Condition** appropriate to the location, such as LATTICE NODE SCARRED or WATCH-SPIRE AURA THINNED.
2. The function works in miniature but turns inward: the caster briefly carries its sound, light, or pressure as a visible tell until a Short Rest.

Module use. This card can create a consequential opening or temporary stabilization without bypassing the module's fixed Area 4 rite or Caeden's final choice.

Card 09 — Judgment's Falling Ember

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Judgment
D&D 5e Counterpart	Fireball

Effect. Name one point within 60 feet. Every creature within 15 feet of that point that you can see takes 4d6 fire damage, or half that amount if the GM judges the creature shielded or bracing. This Phrase does not ignite permanent fires, breach load-bearing structure, or exceed a single burst — it cannot be sustained or repeated in the same breath.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The ember gutters short of its mark. It strikes the nearest legitimate target instead of the named point, at the GM's discretion.
2. The fire answers, but turns inward — the caster takes half the rolled damage, and a visible scorch mark remains on their hands until a Short Rest.

Card 10 — The Unerring Word

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Judgment
D&D 5e Counterpart	Magic Missile

Effect. Name one visible creature within 60 feet. It takes 2d4 force damage. This Phrase cannot be split across multiple targets, cannot be redirected once spoken, and does not require an attack roll — only the printed DC check.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The word lands, but softly — halve the damage, and the target hears its own name spoken back to it in the caster's voice for the rest of the scene.
2. The word misses its mark entirely and strikes the nearest solid surface, leaving a small scorched rune that fades within the hour.

Card 11 — Mercy Poured Out

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Mercy / Chesed
D&D 5e Counterpart	Cure Wounds

Effect. Touch one willing creature. It regains 2d8 hit points. This Phrase does not restore a creature from 0 hit points to consciousness on its own unless the GM determines the wound was not mortal, does not remove a Condition, and cannot be used on the same creature twice in one scene.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The mercy is real but thin — the target regains only half the rolled amount, and feels the caster's own fatigue for a moment.
2. The healing lands on the wrong hurt. The target is restored, but a different, older scar on their body aches sharply until a Short Rest.

Card 12 — The Interposing Hand

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalom
D&D 5e Counterpart	Shield

Effect. Speak this Phrase as a reaction when you are struck or targeted. Until the start of your next turn, you gain a barrier that reduces the triggering effect's severity by the GM's judgment — enough to turn a solid hit into a graze, or a graze into nothing. This Phrase does not stop an effect entirely and cannot be prepared in advance of a specific attack.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The barrier rises a half-second late. You take the blow in full, but the failed Phrase leaves a faint shimmer that makes your next defense easier to call for narratively.
2. The barrier holds, but drains — you feel winded, and your next action this turn is slightly slower to describe and resolve.

Card 13 — Second Skin of the Lattice

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalam
D&D 5e Counterpart	Mage Armor

Effect. Touch one willing, unarmored creature. Until a Long Rest, that creature is notably harder to land a solid hit against — the GM treats ordinary attacks as slightly less likely to connect. This Phrase does not function over existing armor and ends immediately if the target dons armor.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The second skin forms unevenly. It works, but visibly shimmers at the edges, making the target easier to spot in dim light until a Long Rest.
2. The Lattice answers thin. The effect lasts only until the end of the current scene rather than until a Long Rest.

Card 14 — Where the Eye Cannot Follow

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Mystery
D&D 5e Counterpart	Invisibility

Effect. Touch one willing creature. Until it attacks, casts a Phrase, or a scene ends — whichever comes first — it cannot be seen by ordinary sight. This Phrase does not silence sound, mask scent, or defeat senses other than sight, and does not stack with Veil of Unseen Footfalls' tracklessness.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The concealment flickers. The target is faintly visible as a heat-shimmer outline to anyone actively searching.
2. The Phrase takes hold, but loudly — a brief ripple of displaced air is audible to everyone within 30 feet at the moment it activates.

Card 15 — The Borrowed Wing

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Grace
D&D 5e Counterpart	Fly

Effect. Touch one willing creature. Until the end of the scene, it can move through the air at its normal speed. This Phrase does not grant flight in combat maneuvering beyond ordinary movement, and if the effect ends while the target is aloft, the GM adjudicates the descent as a controlled landing unless circumstances clearly prevent one.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The wing catches unevenly. The target can fly, but only at half speed for the scene's first minute.
2. The grace is granted but graceless — the target flies normally, but every takeoff and landing is visibly awkward, narratively costing a moment of surprise or stealth.

Card 16 — The Persuading Warmth

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Grace
D&D 5e Counterpart	Charm Person

Effect. Name one humanoid within 30 feet who can see and hear you. Until a Long Rest, it regards you as a friendly acquaintance and is disinclined toward hostility, provided you and your allies do nothing overtly threatening. This Phrase does not compel specific actions, does not work on a creature already in combat with you, and the target knows it was affected once the duration ends.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The warmth curdles. The target becomes noticeably wary of you specifically, though not hostile, until a Long Rest.
2. The Phrase takes hold of the wrong feeling — the target becomes friendly, but toward the nearest ally instead of you.

Card 17 — The Long Quiet

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalom
D&D 5e Counterpart	Sleep

Effect. Choose a point within 30 feet. Weak or wounded creatures within 10 feet of that point — at the GM's judgment, favoring the most vulnerable first — fall into an ordinary sleep until they take damage, are shaken awake, or a scene ends. This Phrase does not affect creatures the GM judges too strong, too alert, or unliving to be lulled this way.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The quiet settles thin. Only the single weakest eligible creature is affected, rather than the small cluster intended.
2. The Phrase reaches, but late — affected creatures nod off only after one more full turn passes.

Card 18 — The Unspoken Refusal

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Judgment
D&D 5e Counterpart	Counterspell

Effect. Speak this Phrase as a reaction when you see another creature attempt visible magic or a Dabar Phrase within 60 feet. The triggering effect fails to take hold. This Phrase must be spoken before the triggering effect resolves, cannot be held in reserve across scenes, and does not work against the Ashenfold's site-bound legacy formulae.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The refusal is heard a moment too late. The triggering effect resolves in full, and the caster is left momentarily unable to act.
2. The refusal partially lands — the triggering effect resolves at reduced strength or scope, at the GM's judgment, rather than being fully stopped.

Card 19 — Unbinding the Wrongly Bound

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Peace / Shalam
D&D 5e Counterpart	Dispel Magic

Effect. Name one visible ongoing magical or Dabar effect within 30 feet. It ends. This Phrase cannot end a site-bound legacy formula, a module-fixed procedure, or an effect the GM judges to be beyond ordinary Phrase-scale (such as a Lattice-level or Ripple-scale working).

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The unbinding is only partial — the named effect is weakened or shortened rather than ended, at the GM's judgment.
2. The wrong thread is pulled. A different, minor ambient effect nearby ends instead, and the intended target is untouched.

Card 20 — Called Back Before the Door Closes

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Mercy / Chesed
D&D 5e Counterpart	Revivify

Effect. Touch one creature that has died within the last minute, from a wound the GM judges survivable in principle. It returns to life with 1 hit point. This Phrase cannot be used on a creature dead longer than a minute, cannot restore a creature whose body is significantly destroyed, and does not restore lost body parts or remove the cause of death.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The call is heard but the door is already closing — the creature stabilizes at the edge of death but does not fully return; the GM adjudicates it as unconscious and stable rather than alive and active.
2. The mercy is granted, but costly — the creature returns at 1 hit point, and the caster carries a visible mark of the exchange (a chill, a graying lock of hair) until a Long Rest.

Card 21 — The Step Between

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Mystery
D&D 5e Counterpart	Dimension Door

Effect. Choose a location you can clearly picture within 500 feet, with a direct enough sense of it that you could describe it aloud. You and one willing creature you touch instantly arrive there. This Phrase cannot cross into a warded or sealed location without the GM's explicit permission, and cannot be used to bypass a module's fixed procedure (such as the Area 4 rite).

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The step lands short. You and your companion arrive at a location roughly halfway to the intended one, chosen by the GM.
2. The step separates you. You arrive at the intended location; your companion does not, and appears at a nearby but different point instead.

Card 22 — Where the Circle Burns

Field	Value
Level	Consequential
Strain Cost	3
Printed DC	20
Theological Tag	Judgment

Field	Value
D&D 5e Counterpart	Wall of Fire

Effect. Name a line or ring on the ground within 60 feet, no longer than 20 feet in total length. It burns for the rest of the scene. Any creature that moves through it takes 3d6 fire damage; the GM may allow a creature to see and avoid the flame if it is not rushed or blinded. This Phrase does not spread beyond its named boundary and does not ignite standing structures.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The circle burns unevenly, leaving a gap a careful creature could slip through — the GM decides where.
2. The fire answers backward, briefly scorching the ground at the caster's own feet before settling into its intended line.

Card 23 — The Stilled Hand

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Judgment
D&D 5e Counterpart	Hold Person

Effect. Name one humanoid within 30 feet. Until the end of your next turn, it cannot move or act, though it remains aware. This Phrase does not work on a creature already forewarned and actively resisting, and ends immediately if the target takes damage.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The stillness catches only partially — the target is Slowed rather than held, at the GM's judgment, for the same duration.
2. The stillness lands on the caster instead. The caster loses their next action, though they remain aware and can still speak.

Card 24 — The Persuading Whisper

Field	Value
Level	Major
Strain Cost	2
Printed DC	15
Theological Tag	Grace
D&D 5e Counterpart	Suggestion

Effect. Name one creature within 30 feet who can hear and understand you, and describe one reasonable-sounding course of action in a single sentence. Until a Long Rest, the target is inclined to follow that suggestion, provided it does not clearly endanger the target. This Phrase does not compel self-harm, and the target may act on the suggestion in its own way rather than exactly as worded.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The whisper is heard, but resisted — the target considers the suggestion seriously but does not act on it, and grows faintly suspicious of the caster.

2. The suggestion takes hold of the wrong intent — the target follows a related but different course of action than the one intended, at the GM's judgment.

Card 25 — The First Word Spoken

Field	Value
Level	Minor
Strain Cost	1
Printed DC	10
Theological Tag	Grace
D&D 5e Counterpart	Light

Effect. Touch one object no larger than a shield. It sheds bright light in a 20-foot radius until a Long Rest or until you dismiss the effect. This Phrase cannot be cast on a creature or an object another creature is holding without their permission.

Failure Echo — choose one.

1. The light catches dim — it sheds only half the intended radius until a Short Rest, then brightens to normal.
2. The word lands on the wrong object — the nearest other unattended object begins to glow instead of the intended one.

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Card	Level	Cost	DC	Tag	D&D 5e Counterpart
Reading of the Hidden Chord	Minor	1	10	Mystery	Detect Magic
Name the First Boundary	Minor	1	10	Witness	See Invisibility
Veil of Unseen Footfalls	Minor	1	10	Mystery	Pass without Trace
Keep the Unfinished Line	Major	2	15	Peace / Shalam	Protection from Evil and Good
Mercy for the Neglected Thing	Major	2	15	Mercy / Chesed	Mending
Witness the Remaining Light	Major	2	15	Grace	Detect Thoughts
Break the Stutter	Consequential	3	20	Judgment	See Invisibility
Restore the Permitted Measure	Consequential	3	20	Peace / Shalam	Mending
Judgment's Falling Ember	Consequential	3	20	Judgment	Fireball
The Unerring Word	Minor	1	10	Judgment	Magic Missile
Mercy Poured Out	Major	2	15	Mercy / Chesed	Cure Wounds
The Interposing Hand	Minor	1	10	Peace / Shalam	Shield
Second Skin of the Lattice	Minor	1	10	Peace / Shalam	Mage Armor
Where the Eye Cannot Follow	Major	2	15	Mystery	Invisibility
The Borrowed Wing	Major	2	15	Grace	Fly
The Persuading Warmth	Major	2	15	Grace	Charm Person
The Long Quiet	Major	2	15	Peace / Shalam	Sleep
The Unspoken Refusal	Consequential	3	20	Judgment	Counterspell
Unbinding the Wrongly Bound	Major	2	15	Peace / Shalam	Dispel Magic

Card	Level	Cost	DC	Tag	D&D 5e Counterpart
Called Back Before the Door Closes	Consequential	3	20	Mercy / Chesed	Revivify
The Step Between	Consequential	3	20	Mystery	Dimension Door
Where the Circle Burns	Consequential	3	20	Judgment	Wall of Fire
The Stilled Hand	Major	2	15	Judgment	Hold Person
The Persuading Whisper	Major	2	15	Grace	Suggestion
The First Word Spoken	Minor	1	10	Grace	Light

Boundary reminders

These cards use the ordinary MVP system. A caster chooses one prepared Phrase, states intent, marks its printed cost, and rolls once against its printed DC. A theological tag guides the direction of the consequence; it is not a roll modifier and does not create an effect that the card does not print.

A failed Phrase uses its printed Failure Echo. A natural 1 adds a minor narrative complication. A failed Phrase does not automatically create a Condition unless the card says so; reaching 5 Strain and failing or attempting a risky Phrase creates a Personal Condition under the Master Reference, and Force It at 6 Strain always creates a Personal Condition and may create a Local Condition.

Campaign Ripple Drift is not changed after ordinary casts. Apply the module's outcome value at the end of the module. World Drift Score, exact glyph arithmetic, Vertical Friction, and other advanced systems remain outside ordinary Phrase resolution unless a separate, explicitly labeled module procedure invokes them.

Reference

[1]: /home/ubuntu/upload/Rules&MechanicsMasterReferencei.txt — *The Threl — Canon Rules & Mechanics Master Reference*, Version 1.0, updated 2026-08-30.

Combined Design Notes

- All 17 cards stay within this packet's existing three-tier structure (Minor/1/DC10, Major/2/DC15, Consequential/3/DC20) rather than introducing a fourth tier, even for spells (Fireball, Revivify) that would normally sit at a higher power level in full 5e. Their effects were bounded down to fit — smaller damage dice, shorter durations, narrower scope — consistent with how the original 8 cards each undercut their D&D analogue's full power (e.g. Restore the Permitted Measure vs. full Mending, Keep the Unfinished Line vs. true Wall of Force immobility).
- These are the **first damage-dealing cards** in this card system — the original 8 were entirely utility/non-combat. Damage numbers (1d4 through 4d6 depending on tier) are a new design choice for this expansion, not carried over from anything in the source packet, and should be treated as a first draft for playtesting.
- Theological tags reuse the six already established (Mystery, Witness, Peace/Shalam, Mercy/Chesed, Grace, Judgment) rather than inventing new ones, mapped loosely to the Triune Orders' established domains (Judgment → Father/Law; Mercy, Grace, Peace → Son; Mystery → Spirit).